

ill Visuals

Roadmap to 1,000 Monthly Subscribers

Marketing Strategy | Social Media | Paid Ads | Budgeting

Context

Product: ill Visuals -- professional projection mapping & VJ performance software (Windows, macOS coming).
Subscription tiers: Demo (free/watermarked), Starter, Pro. AI credits as add-on revenue. Currently v0.1.0.

Goal: 1,000 paying monthly subscribers from a standing start.

Competitive landscape: Resolume Arena (~\$799 perpetual), MadMapper (~\$449 perpetual), TouchDesigner (free non-commercial / \$600+). A subscription model at a lower price point is a real differentiator.

Phase 0: Foundation (Weeks 1-2)

Brand & Web Presence

- Launch website (illvisuals.com) using existing landing page as base
- Hero video (30-60s sizzle reel), feature highlights, pricing page, email capture, Discord invite
- Set up accounts: Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, X/Twitter, Discord server
- Branding kit: consistent profile images, banners, dark + cyan color scheme

Pricing Strategy

Tier	Price	Target Audience
Demo	Free	Trial / hobbyists
Starter	\$14.99/mo (\$149/yr)	Freelance VJs, students
Pro	\$29.99/mo (\$299/yr)	Professional VJs, event companies
AI Credits	\$4.99 per pack	Power users

At \$20 blended ARPU, 1,000 subs = \$20k MRR. Achievable in 6-9 months.

Phase 1: Content Engine (Weeks 2-6)

Social Media Strategy

1. Instagram Reels / TikTok -- #1 Priority

Post 4-5x/week minimum. Content types:

- 15-30s clips of shaders running to music (use trending audio)
- "How I mapped this building" process videos
- Before/after of raw venue vs. mapped venue
- Three-Body orbital visualizations (science + art = viral potential)
- AI shader generation demos ("I typed this prompt and got THIS")
- Side-by-side comparisons with competitor workflows

Hashtags: #projectionmapping #vjlife #visualart #generativeart #liveevent #vj #resolume #madmapper #touchdesigner

2. YouTube -- Long-form Authority

- Tutorials: "Projection Mapping 101 with ill Visuals"
- "Shader Spotlight" series (one shader, creative uses)
- Live performance recordings
- "Build a VJ set from scratch" walk-throughs
- YouTube Shorts: repurpose TikTok/Reels content

3. X/Twitter -- Community Building

- Daily posts: dev updates, shader GIFs, polls, replies to VJ community
- Thread format: "310 shaders. Here are the 10 most mind-bending ones"
- Engage with #vjtwitter, #creativecoding communities

4. Discord -- Retention & Community

- Channels: #showcase, #help, #feature-requests, #shader-share, #gigs-board
- Weekly "Visual Jam" events -- users share creations
- Direct feedback line -- builds loyalty + reduces churn

5. Reddit -- Seeding

- Post demos to: r/vjing, r/projectionmapping, r/generativeart, r/creativecoding, r/threejs
- Share cool visuals, answer questions, mention the tool naturally

Content Production Workflow

- Screen record interesting shader combos and mapping setups daily (5 min)
- Batch edit into 5+ short clips weekly
- Cross-post everywhere with platform-native formatting
- Tools: OBS (record), CapCut or DaVinci Resolve (edit), Later or Buffer (schedule)

Phase 2: Paid Acquisition (Weeks 4-12)

Monthly Budget Allocation

Channel	Monthly Budget	Goal
Instagram / Facebook Ads	\$500 - \$800	Awareness + trials
YouTube Ads	\$200 - \$400	Tutorial pre-rolls for VJ audiences
Google Search Ads	\$200 - \$300	Capture "projection mapping software" intent
Reddit Ads	\$100 - \$200	Niche targeting r/vjing, r/projectionmapping
TOTAL	\$1,000 - \$1,700/mo	

Ad Strategy Detail

Instagram / Facebook (biggest spend)

- Creative: 15s video ads with stunning shader/mapping output
- Targeting: VJ software interests, Resolume/MadMapper audiences, lookalike from email list
- Retarget website visitors who did not convert

Funnel: Ad --> Landing page --> Free Demo download --> Email nurture --> Convert to Starter/Pro

Expected CPA: \$5-15 per trial, \$30-80 per paying subscriber

YouTube

- Pre-roll ads on VJ tutorials, projection mapping videos, Resolume tutorials
- 6-second bumper ads: one stunning visual + "Free to try. illvisuals.com"

Google Search

- Keywords: "projection mapping software", "VJ software", "alternative to Resolume"
- Expected CPC: \$1-3 for niche keywords

Reddit

- Promoted posts in VJ/creative subreddits
- Native-feeling: demo video + "we just launched this, feedback welcome"

Key Metrics to Track

- **CAC (Customer Acquisition Cost): Target < \$50 per paying subscriber**
- **Trial-to-paid conversion: Target 10-15%**
- **Monthly churn: Target < 5%**
- **Budget ~\$50k total ad spend over 6-9 months (front-loaded, then organic takes over)**

Phase 3: Growth Levers (Ongoing)

1. Influencer / Creator Partnerships

- Identify 10-20 VJs and visual artists with 5k-50k followers
- Offer: Free Pro license + AI credits for 2-3 posts/month
- Cost: \$0 cash outlay (just free licenses) -- massive ROI
- Target creators on Resolume/MadMapper -- "switching" content is highly engaging

2. Event Presence

- Sponsor/demo at: MUTEK, LPM, AV festivals, local VJ meetups
- Live projection mapping demos -- let people try the software
- Budget: \$500-1,000 per event (travel + booth)

3. Educational Content & SEO

Write 2-4 blog posts/month targeting:

- "How to projection map a building"
- "Best VJ software 2026"
- "Gaussian splat visualization tools"
- "AI-generated shaders for live performance"

Each post --> email capture --> nurture sequence --> trial --> paid

4. Referral Program

- Existing subscribers get 1 month free for each successful referral
- Viral loop: creators share work --> followers ask "what tool is that?" --> referral link

5. Free Tier as Funnel

- The watermarked Demo tier is your best growth tool
- Dead simple to download and try
- Watermark: subtle enough for content creation, annoying enough to upgrade

Monthly Budget Summary

Category	Month 1-3	Month 4-6	Month 7-9
Paid Ads	\$1,200	\$1,500	\$1,000 (organic growing)
Content Tools	\$50	\$50	\$50
Influencer (free licenses)	\$0	\$0	\$0
Events (1/quarter)	\$0	\$800	\$0
TOTAL	\$1,250	\$2,350	\$1,050

9-month total: ~\$12,000 - \$15,000

Subscriber Growth Trajectory

Month	New Subs	Cumulative (net ~5% churn)	Revenue (@ \$20 ARPU)
1	30	30	\$600
2	50	75	\$1,500
3	80	145	\$2,900
4	120	255	\$5,100
5	150	390	\$7,800
6	180	545	\$10,900
7	180	695	\$13,900
8	180	835	\$16,700
9	180	975	\$19,500
10	150	1,075	\$21,500

Organic grows as paid stabilizes. 1,000 subs achievable in ~9-10 months.

Week 1 Action Items

- 1. Register domain, deploy landing page
 - 2. Create Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, X accounts
 - 3. Set up Discord server with channel structure
 - 4. Record 10 screen captures of best shader/mapping demos
 - 5. Edit into 15-20 short clips (batch content for 2 weeks)
 - 6. Set up Buffer/Later for cross-platform scheduling
 - 7. Finalize pricing tiers and integrate payment (Stripe)
 - 8. Create first YouTube tutorial: "ill Visuals in 5 Minutes"
 - 9. Draft first 3 Instagram/Facebook ad creatives
 - 10. Identify 10 VJ influencers to reach out to
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Success Milestones

- ◆ **Week 2: Website live, social accounts active, first 10 posts published**
- ◆ **Month 1: 100+ email signups, 50+ Demo downloads, 30 paid subs**
- ◆ **Month 3: 500+ Discord members, 145 paid subs, CAC trending below \$50**
- ◆ **Month 6: 545 paid subs, organic traffic exceeding paid, influencer referrals active**
- ◆ **Month 9-10: 1,000 paid subscribers, \$20k MRR**